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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, May 7, 2020

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Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	2h 11m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qZ239POaKFM
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-26. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:01:22] good afternoon that is that sonia yes all right there now jamelle can you do a test real quick are you there yes i can hear you we're live now okay so yeah change devices i've got a laptop

[00:01:54] ipad and iphone i'm gonna turn on my jetpack and i should be okay all right good okay and just um

[00:02:04] just so folks know we are live on our youtube page right now emily can you hear me yes ma'am

[00:03:21] i can hear you okay um remind it is a little quiet but i can hear you hey emily can you hear me now

[00:03:55] is that sam yeah yes i can hear you okay and just so folks know we are um live on our youtube page emily can you hear me yes diane i can hear you thank you emily it's susan williams can you hear me yes susan i can oh good hopefully this technology holds hi tammy i can hear you

[00:04:34] actually my internet connection has been fairly unstable i don't know if they're just a lot of people uh using zoom in this area or on the internet but i'm going to try to use the chat function okay okay just yeah one um tammy one other thing that may be helpful that i know when i have an unstable internet connection is i just take my video down so that i'm only running on

[00:04:59] audio and that often seems to help as well okay thank you i've got to be one who are we missing let's see i think i can't i don't know if that i can see everybody all right we have diane we have

[00:05:30] um jamelle we have tammy dr lane pam francisco ann is there looks like we may be i'm trying to see if i see keisha i do see keisha there she is muted right now but she is on um so i get started we'll do the roll call yeah let's go ahead and ready is dr lane on yes dr lane is on good good - Good afternoon.

[00:06:04] - Yeah, good afternoon, James. Okay, we're gonna call the meeting, virtual meeting of the Board of Education to order. Because we are not all in the same room, we're gonna do the roll call. Ms. Atkinson?

[00:06:19] - Present. - Ms. Davis Vaught, I know I saw her before. Thank you, Dr. Duran? - Present. - Ms. Holton? - Present, good morning all.

[00:06:35] - Good morning, Dr. Mann? - Good afternoon. - Present. - Dr. Paxton. - Present. - And Dr. Wilson. - Present. - Perfect.

[00:06:50] First order of business will be the approval of the minutes from various board meetings. As you know, this is the first board meeting we've had in a while in which we conduct regular business. This was made possible by, I guess, language recently passed by the legislature.

[00:07:07] So have you had a chance to review the minutes of our January 22 and 23 meetings, the March 20 meeting and the April 2 meeting? And if so, and if there are no changes, can we have a motion to adopt those minutes or a motion to adopt with revisions?

[00:07:26] - And move, make a motion to adopt the minutes. - Thank you, Dr. Duran, is there a second? - Second, this is Dr. Wilson. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson, and just to be sure because this platform is so difficult at times to do, did anybody have any objections or corrections for the minutes?

[00:07:46] - I did, I had one, Dr. Gecker. The April 7th minutes associated comments that I made regarding social emotional resources and I actually believe it was Ms. Davis' fault that made those comments.

[00:08:03] I certainly endorse them as a mental health professional but I wanted to make sure the minutes reflected that accurately. - That's the April 2 meeting minutes? - Yes. - Correct. - We can make that change and we'll make sure that that's noted correctly before we post the final minutes.

[00:08:26] - Right, I assume Ms. Davis-Faught, there's no objection to that? - No objection, sir. - Thank you very much. All right, I guess what all votes by roll call today is what Emily has told me. So we have a motion to approve the minutes as corrected.

[00:08:43] Ms. Atkinson? - Aye. - Ms. Davis-Faught? - Aye. - Dr. Duran? - Aye. - Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann. Aye. Dr. Pexton. Aye. Dr. Wilson.

[00:08:58] Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. Good afternoon. Welcome to our virtual meeting. Board members and staff are each in a safe location for today's meeting, which is being streamed live on the VDOE YouTube channel and on the board's public meeting webpage.

[00:09:14] We'd like to welcome those joining us in the live stream from across the Commonwealth. A couple of things to note about this meeting. one, the board accepted written public comment for the meeting. All comments that were received by 5 p.m. yesterday have been uploaded to our meeting

webpage. Comments received after 5 p.m. will be provided to the board in a timely manner and posted on our meeting webpage. As those of you who have come to our meetings know, the board takes public comments seriously. Honestly, this is the only way we could accommodate it, you know, and meet this way. Number two, for our YouTube watchers, the chat

[00:09:52] feature is not being monitored by staff the best way to contact the board is by email at boe that's board of ed initials at doe.va or excuse me dot virginia.gov uh three since we are meeting virtually there is a need for a roll call vote as you just saw for each item uh please be sure to speak clearly so staff can accurately capture your vote for the meeting minutes and four the board does intend to take a 10-minute break around 2:30 p.m. There will be a slide up on the screen indicating we are in that break when it comes. And finally, before we move into the agenda, we would be remiss

[00:10:31] if we didn't recognize Teacher Appreciation Week, May 4th through May 8th. This is a time to express our immense gratitude to our hardworking educators who, through this pandemic, have shown grace, creativity, innovation, and dedication to their students and their craft. Our teachers have been resilient and continue to work well beyond the school day preparing lesson plans learning new technology and serving as mentors and a support system for our young people and their families while we have long known that teachers are not paid enough for the impact they have in our society we know that so many parents grandparents and guardians have seen firsthand over the

[00:11:07] last few weeks what a challenging job educating our young people is to our teachers we know that you miss your students and your students miss you and our parents miss you the most We can't wait for everyone to be back in school for the many contributions our educators make daily to their students to their schools and to their communities. We thank all of Virginia's teachers for their dedication and service. Okay, we will move on. Thank you, Ms. Halton.

[00:11:38] We will move on to the consent agenda. There are five items on that agenda. Does anyone want to pull anything from the consent agenda or is there a motion to adopt the consent agenda in its entire move to adopt the consent agenda agenda in its entirety this is diane atkinson thank you miss atkinson is there a second to that motion i will second dr duran thank you uh and as before

[00:12:09] everything by roll call miss atkinson aye miss davis fault aye dr duran bye miss holton aye Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. And I vote aye. Okay, going to move on to item F, which is the first of the action discussion items. This is the final review of recommended cut scores for grades three to eight, and then of course standards of learning reading tests based upon the 2017 English standards. You all may remember that this has come up before. We were

[00:12:48] engaged in a fairly significant discussion about this, and I, frankly, personally consider this to be a particularly important item. Because we have delayed SOL assessments for this spring, and it was announced that there will be none in the fall, the urgency of setting the cut scores today has been significantly lessened. Because I believe that the interaction among the board on this important topic would be much more valuable in person, it would be my preference to move this item to a subsequent agenda when we are meeting back together.

[00:13:24] However, I will open the floor for discussion on that now. If anybody has got a contrary opinion, please let us know. Mr. President, I don't have a contrary opinion. I want to just agree with you and second that, and I think that having an in-person conversation about this would be very meaningful and helpful.

[00:13:43] Thank you for bringing that up. I fully support that. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there anybody else who'd like to comment on this issue? i concur this is tammy mann with what's been stated i would appreciate that opportunity thank you dr mann anyone else and again i know this is awkward because i can't really see all of you uh you know the body language looking to speak so if anybody wants to my my goal here is to move through expeditiously but not such that we cut anybody off who has anything to say

[00:14:15] thank you mr gecker i totally agree thank you very much okay uh hearing no dissension to this we're going to go ahead and move this item to the next agenda where we may defer it again, depending upon how we're meeting. We're going to call in item G, the final review of Virginia's Perkins 5 plan, state plan. Excuse me, Mr. President Gecker. This is Jamel Wilson. I just have a question. Do you need a motion formally to move this item since it is listed as action?

[00:14:52] i actually think and uh i guess susan's on the phone i think i can do it as a chair's prerogative but susan is that right i do think that would be the best way to go simply because you approved the agenda and the way it was drafted so yeah which is the best take a vote or to yeah yes take a vote i'm sorry all right well thank you dr wilson then we'll take a vote uh so the motion is to defer this item to uh the next meeting i second that thank you

[00:15:19] Ms. Atkinson? Aye. Ms. Davis-Fault? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. And I vote aye. Thank you very much.

[00:15:37] All right, now we'll move to item G, final review of the Perkins Plan. Mr. Wilcox? Good afternoon, Mr. Dutton. How are you, sir? Fine, and you and members of the board. i will say sir before you start and i should have mentioned this at the beginning how delighted i am to be able to see all of you again uh it seems it has been much much too long both for the board and for the members of the department who support the board's work so ably so i hope you're doing well mr wilcox and we look forward to the presentation thank you and we certainly appreciate the

[00:16:16] leadership the board is providing in this challenging period. Today we present for final review the Perkins V four-year state plan. May advance the slide. As required by the Code of Virginia, the Board of Education has administrative responsibility for carrying out the provisions

[00:16:50] of the carl d perkins act as well as its subs subsequent acts this program serves over 650 000 students annually across the common commonwealth following the report and first review by the board at its January meeting, the staff has focused on the following primary areas: consideration of

[00:17:24] establishing a reserve fund, providing the public a 60-day public comment period, and also compiled information per your request pertaining to the utilization of state leadership funds and state staff next slide next slide is that george have i gone too far uh right there thank you okay

[00:17:57] emily i'm not seeing the slides at all um maybe others are i'll just pull them up separately can can i just real quick can others see the slides that i'm sharing i can see that yes i can see yes okay magnify pretty large so i can't really maybe i did something on my screen to change the zoom function but well okay i've got them now i don't know what i did but i had done something now i've got them and um if if by chance there are folks that can't see them they um board members they're

[00:18:31] in your electronic board book and for the public they're also posted on uh the public meeting webpage in advance one slide please okay this slide provides a summary of the federal requirement in terms of ways in which the reserve fund may be used in terms of rural areas of areas with high

[00:19:04] percentages of of of cte concentrators high numbers of concentrators and particularly areas that have disparities or gaps in performance. Those were key factors that the staff considered along with Dr. Lane in studying options for establishing a reserve fund. Next slide.

[00:19:39] at the january meeting this is a summary slide of what we pre presented with a 10-year projection of anticipated revenue based on a 10-year pro pro projection and in looking at a 10-year projection we had averaged a five percent increase in perkins funding each each year however since

[00:20:17] the january meeting we have in fact received our actual allocation for the 2021 uh school year and those numbers came in substantially under the five percent but slightly above uh what we had previously received and if you move to the the next slide emily this slide pre presents the same

[00:20:54] concept of a 10-year projection and phasing of a reserve fund based on our actual 2021 estimated grant award, which is $28,777,108. This 10-year plan moves from a 1.6%

[00:21:26] reserve fund establishment to a four percent reserve fund establishment in a three-year window. We were careful here to ensure that all school divisions would continue to receive a degree of increase each year and also maintain the 85-15 split of funds between secondary and and post-secondary.

[00:22:01] During the public comment period, there was considerable comment as you have in the extensive report of the plan on school division support of maintaining the 85-15 split.

[00:22:21] Dr. Lane may at some point want to speak to the establishment of the reserve fund, but we have spent considerable time in ensuring that if the state established a fund, that school divisions would continue to receive an increase as well as being able to have focused services across the state.

[00:22:49] Next slide. - George, if you don't mind, I'll just interject real quick. Since you opened the door for that. Board members, as Mr. Wilcox shared, Slide four was our presentation in January.

[00:23:06] Slide five was updated based on your request and recommendation. And the board was essentially asking us to see how we could get quicker to the rates at which you would like to see us be able to fund some of the priorities, for instance, work-based learning coordinators.

[00:23:23] We did maintain through any of these the 85-15 split between secondary and post-secondary. But this would be a policy question for the board before you vote on the plan, whether you would want to go with the projection on slide four or the projection on slide five.

[00:23:38] Once we were able to see that based on the way that this is laid out, that no one would be reduced from their current allocation as they move forward, even though, at least in the first couple of years, it's slight increases. I just wanted to clarify that our recommendation is to go with the reserve fund and to produce it as it is on slide five.

[00:24:11] Thank you Dr. Lane. Next slide. Other areas in which we discussed during the January meeting and continue to receive support from the field was that the state would utilize two of the three quality indicators, those being recognized post-secondary credential and work-based learning.

[00:24:44] David Moore: slide six and seven provide a summary statement are pertaining to both both of those types of quality indicators next slide. David Moore: The recognized post secondary credential measures that percentage of CTE concentrators graduating from high school with a recognized post secondary credential and next slide which is work based learning measures.

[00:25:17] The percentage of CTE concentrators graduating from high school in sustaining instructional practices pertaining to industry.

[00:25:32] Next slide. We also discussed at the January meeting that we had worked close with the Accountability and Assessment Office and establishing the target levels for each of the rates that we must report on.

[00:26:00] This chart provides a summary of those. And in each of those cases, as reported to you a year ago in the annual report, our actual outcomes have been slightly above these projection targets that are being prepared for submission in the state plan.

[00:26:25] Next slide. And I'll yield now to Dr. David Esherman, who will discuss state leadership activities and a couple of other important points.

[00:26:43] - Thank you, Mr. Wilcox. And good afternoon, President Gecker, members of the board and Dr. Lane. It's a pleasure to serve the Commonwealth. Under the first review of the Perkins V state plan, The board did discuss the split of funds in the reserve funds and requested under second review that we provide additional information.

[00:27:04] related to how state leadership funding was being used and a great place to start is understanding. that when Virginia receives federal funds, it is split between state funds up to 15% and local funds.

[00:27:21] So looking at the state funds up to 15%, 5% is identified for administrative funds, which I'll talk about a little bit later in the presentation. But what I wanna talk about and what this slide is in front of you, there are four slides that I'm gonna go through provide additional clarity related to state leadership funds and we we encumber up to 10 percent under state leadership funds in the slide that is before you or was before you that will

[00:27:59] come back up okay this slide is the first category back go back one sorry this is the first category that identifies required use of leadership funds, and Perkins V does require up to 2% of the leadership allocation go to institutions. Currently, Virginia allocates 0.7%, so we are under that 2% cap for institutions, and those institutions are the Department of Corrections

[00:28:32] and the Department of Juvenile Justice. Also required under state leadership is funding allocated for services that prepare individuals for non-traditional fields and we in Virginia have funding set aside to do that through the Weldon Cooper Center and they also provide what we call our trailblazers which provides school divisions high quality data looking at demographics and labor market data along with policy and program analysis also in

[00:29:11] this required category is a completer follow-up survey and Perkins V continues that requirement where we study program completers following high school graduation and Virginia conducts the study one year after graduation. Also in this category is a requirement through the U.S.

[00:29:33] Department of Education that requires grant recipients to conduct local on-site monitoring of sub-recipients so all of this is under what we call our category of required leadership and that's funded through our leadership funds the next slide is it is another category that we are targeting in certain focused areas where we want to pay particular attention particularly as we move forward with Perkins 5 and something that's new the first one that there that's on the

[00:30:12] on this slide is a state affiliation for NAEP which stands for the National Alliance for Partnerships and Equity and this is an opportunity for the state of Virginia to have an affiliation and by us doing this each of the local school divisions would actually be able to affiliate and benefit from the resources aligned to non-traditional careers as well as get those services at a reduced cost since the state would be affiliated. So that is an item that's new.

[00:30:48] Under this area, we are also looking at expanding services for the academic career plan portfolio, which is a requirement, and this will expand services that we provide through CareerView to actually include a career plan portfolio for students in Virginia. Also on this category of is expanded services for a new teacher institute this is a category that we've been doing but it's been expanding and it's instructionally designed

[00:31:24] specifically for CTE teachers who are transitioning directly from business and industry to the classroom it's a fantastic opportunity for professional development which in our case moving forward right now will be online but but we're looking to expand those opportunities and the numbers and the interest continues to increase.

[00:31:47] And lastly on this category is expanded services for experienced works, which is an opportunity that we convene business and industry and educators around work-based learning opportunities. And this is also another category that has been expanding.

[00:32:04] It's been something we've been providing And we've gotten positive feedback from our stakeholders and look forward to this experience expanding around work-based learning opportunities and its understanding.

[00:32:20] Next slide. This category is supporting state leadership activities. And the first item that's there is some funding that we do set aside for the Virginia Community College System.

[00:32:36] And it's primarily focused on providing leadership opportunities in the implementation of Perkins V at the post-secondary level. The next category is our livelihood, is our Curriculum Resource Center.

[00:32:53] And this is the CTE unit for the development of instructional services and competencies for courses offered at the middle school and high school level throughout the Commonwealth of Virginia. And this staff is focused on writing and editing and distributing curriculum framework statewide, supporting in-service presentations, training programs, supporting school divisions with curriculum projects, facilitating meetings of businesses and industry professionals.

[00:33:24] The list goes on and on with the services that are provided and these services are mission critical in the expansion and development of our ever-continuing curriculum. Also in this category are agency affiliations, and one of those is the Southern Regional Education Board that Virginia has participated in.

[00:33:48] Currently, Governor Northam is serving as chair. The Career Technical Education Consortium of States, Virginia is a charter member, and this serves as an assessment provider for the workplace readiness skills.

[00:34:04] This is definitely an affiliation that supports teachers and school divisions throughout the Commonwealth. And another category under agency affiliations is advanced CTE, which is a national

organization supporting state implementation of Perkins.

[00:34:22] And this has been a vital resource for Virginia as we collaborate with other states working to drive what's best for students. In addition, in this category is our Career Success Stars.

[00:34:39] This is a project that we have been expanding, supporting students and having a better understanding, hearing directly from Virginia graduates. And now it's expanding to the 17th career cluster by adding energy.

[00:34:55] These are short video clips that are on our website. They're made available to school divisions, and it's a great place for students to be able to hear directly from Virginia graduates in how they proceeded through their pathway. And now that they're in the workforce, we get to hear back from them really how important their education was and the experiences that provided them the opportunities leading to their career.

[00:35:22] In addition, in this category is the Virginia Career Wizard, which we are currently working with stakeholders throughout the Commonwealth, looking to continue to expand services in this category, which is providing career information and enrollment in Virginia community colleges, college transfer to four-year colleges, college debt.

[00:35:45] There's a lot of information there and we're really excited to support that moving forward, particularly with providing some additional directions in the end products and what's there to support students, even beyond secondary education.

[00:36:05] Also in this category is an area that supports career clusters, which is all of our program areas. And this ranges from curriculum development, teacher training, professional in-services, legislative regulations, industry credential alignment.

[00:36:20] I mean, this list continues to go on and on. And it's supporting all of our curricular program areas and our curriculum specialists, as they work with school divisions throughout the Commonwealth. The next slide. And this slide is merely there to give you the overall of our state leadership funding.

[00:36:42] It is 2.8 million. You can see the categories that I just broke down for you. And that total provides mission critical support for Virginia, not only currently, but particularly with moving forward with the implementation of Perkins V.

[00:37:01] The next slide. This slide, and I know people probably watching this from YouTube can't see this, but you can zoom in on it. When we talked about the 5% in state funds under administration, what you'll see on here is after our staff member's name or position, you'll see an F and that's for federal funds.

[00:37:27] So we identified every position that falls under that 5% allocation, which was also requested. Thank you. - Okay, well, thank you very much, both of you, Dr. Eshelman and Mr. Wilcox.

[00:37:46] Any comments from members of the board? Dr. Lane, do you have anything you wanna say first? You know, it might be helpful, Emily, if we could lead slide five up, is that okay? - Yeah, and Mr. Geckner, that's what I was gonna share with you.

[00:38:01] Emily and I had a quick sidebar while you were here in the presentation. The slide five that was on the screen was not the slide five that's in your packet, so I've asked Emily to show the slide five in your packet that is our recommendation so Emily can you pull that up yes and I just want to make there it is yep the slide 5 that showed on the screen when we were talking before was not this slide but this is what is in

your board book and what's on the public page and this was our recommendation in March and remains our recommendation still maintains the 85/15 split but it does have the faster

[00:38:36] allocation of the reserve fund so I just wanted to clarify that because I was I was looking at your board book and it came to my attention that you did not have this version on your screen i thought part of the presentation was building up to four percent in three years as opposed to looks like one yeah so at the at the last board meeting the board asked if we could show a version of it that got it quicker and i wanted to make sure that we would not see secondary reduced in funds when we got this before your march board meeting we were able

[00:39:13] to show that secondary would not have a reduction in funds and we could get to the number faster so based on the board's feedback at the last one once once we saw that that did not lead to a decline uh our our march recommendation changed to this quicker projection to to the four percent and then escalating to the full 15. okay are there any uh comments or questions by members of the board mr gecker i have one question this is a yes thank you uh just a clarification the increase that we are showing or anticipating, well, first, let me say it does make sense to me

[00:39:52] to recognize what we now have as an actual for fiscal year, the 2021 year. So that makes sense. But my question is whether or not the increase that we anticipate year on year is 100% of the increase only.

[00:40:11] Is that 100% of that increase going to the reserve, or is there a portion of that increase that goes to the reserve and another portion that goes to the secondary and post-secondary 85-15 split?

[00:40:29] Can you make sure you clarify that for me, James? Thanks. Yes. Thank you, Dr. Wilson. If you look at what we have on the screen now, you will see that in the first year while While we're first creating the fund, a majority of the increase goes to create the reserve and only about 160, 170,000 goes to secondary and new funds and 30 or 40,000 in post-secondary.

[00:40:56] But in subsequent years, you can see after the creation of the reserve fund, the reserve fund, the secondary fund, and the post-secondary fund all increase much more significantly year in, year out. um as as the funds escalate um all sectors there get additional funds thanks for that i just want to i think it's important for us to acknowledge that uh as we see increases that our localities will also see some level of increase and we are not holding them steady uh i think that's an

[00:41:31] important thing to to emphasize thanks yep thank you dr wilson you'll see by the end of the 10-year projection secondary as an example we'll see nearly a 40 percent increase over their current funding anybody else on the board have any comments or questions um this is diane atkinson um i just want to say that i think you know when we look at what we're supporting through the development of that fund i think it's very um hand in glove with the work that we have done with the profile of

[00:42:06] a virginia graduate and want to actually thank staff for giving us that additional information because i think it was really illuminating for me to see how those funds would be used okay thank you miss atkinson anybody else i don't hear anybody else and like i said i can't really see everybody on the screen at the same time so uh i guess we're at the point now where you want a motion to adopt basically uh the slide five and the rest of the plan as uh the board's recommendation

[00:42:44] going forward so moved thank you miss atkinson second second sorry i missed the second second thank you miss davis vodt all right we'll do roll call again miss atkinson aye miss davis vodt aye dr

duran aye miss holton aye dr mann aye dr pexton aye dr wilson aye now but i also okay that carries thank you very much uh and thanks to both uh mr wilcox and dr eshelman

[00:43:23] uh mr wilcox i guess you're up again for item h thank you president decker pursuant to governor norton's executive order 53 and 55 schools and businesses across the commonwealth closed to protect public health and safety as a result of the closure students students who enrolled

[00:43:59] in cooperative education and internship experiences will not be able to complete the required hours of on-the-job training the the board established the emergency guidelines for local alternatives to awarding standard units of credit at its april 2nd 2020 meeting the board approved

[00:44:31] CTE Work-Based Learning Guide allows students to undertake and complete 11 different methods of work-based learning without sacrificing rigor. Students participating in cooperative education and internship complete 280 hours during the school year. In order to provide school divisions emergency flexibility in instructional experiences pertaining to co-op and internship

[00:45:09] this item presents to the board an option for reducing the 280 hours of required on-the-job training to a hundred and forty hours for school year 2019-20 to 2019-20 okay are there any questions

[00:45:38] from the board i'm not seeing or hearing anyone so uh the superintendent has requested that we approve these is there a motion to do that so moved hang on uh dr wilson was that you on the motion or the second? That was me on the motion. Thank you. And the second? Tammy Mann. Thank you.

[00:46:10] And again, I apologize. This is not as easy as it may look. So roll call on this one. Ms. Atkinson? Aye. Ms. Davis-Faught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay, that covers item H.

[00:46:37] thank you item i final review of the proposed revisions to family life education board of ed guidelines and standards of learning for virginia public schools dr hollins thank you so much president gecker good afternoon board members president gecker vice president atkinson and dr lane i'm with you today to speak briefly about the final review of proposed revisions to the family life education the family life education uh guidelines and standards so this is something that the board had for first review their January meeting and we had some additional

[00:47:15] opportunity to seek public comment and held two sessions, one in February in Williamsburg and one in March in Roanoke and I want to take this opportunity to thank Ms. Atkinson, Dr. Wilson and Ms. Davis Vaught for their collaboration with us and helping to manage those opportunities. It was really a great opportunity to hear from the field and get some additional information on the standards and so i hope we'll have an opportunity to review some of that information that was shared with us after the public hearings staff took that information as you can see in the board item made sure to summarize all of it and also identify where some of the areas for update

[00:47:51] and changes could be made and where other items lent themselves to a more comprehensive review of these standards as a reminder the review that we're looking at today contains updates and changes that are as a result of general assembly legislation from both the session in 2018 and 2019 we had a stakeholder group that was made up of practitioners and teachers of family life education in the commonwealth meet to review the pieces of legislation and to integrate that new content into the relevant standards and so the table that you have really does a nice job of summarizing that information and walking through each of the pieces of legislation

[00:48:30] that were appropriate to include and thus update the standards i do want to make a note as i wrap up my very brief remarks that obviously you can see from the quality and quantity of stakeholder feedback i think the item that we discussed in january still holds true that we are still seeking and preparing to do a more comprehensive review of the family life education standards i've spoken at length with my colleague and teaching and learning assistant superintendent michael bowling and once we are able to take the time to gather additional input and take into consideration all that was shared with us the board and excuse me the department will be seeking

[00:49:07] to do a comprehensive review of these standards in partnership across the two departments in order to make sure that many of the questions and concerns we heard from the field will be answered i think a lot of things we heard from folks are the need to be hooked into some curriculum resources as well as just some of these more relevant and recent updates from the general assembly just the need to have folks in the field understand how they can appropriately address them and integrate them into their current instruction so with that i will bring my comments to a close i'm more than happy to take any comments or answer any questions that the board has members of the board are there

[00:49:43] thank you dr hollinson members of the board are there any uh comments or questions at this time or discussion on this item um this is diane atkinson um based on the public comment that we received in williamsburg um one of the things i would suggest uh maybe ask is that when we send these out that we acknowledge up front that it was not a comprehensive review and and that the changes embedded in the new standards are those that are just reflective of um the requirements

[00:50:17] from a recent legislation i be folks were very um clear about their concern about the process and i appreciate the fact that the process was not as extensive as we would do if we were had done a comprehensive review and so i just want to acknowledge on the front end that the circumstances and let them understand when they get the these that they are sorry about the phone ringing in the background um that they are merely reflective of changes required by the general assembly

[00:50:55] thank you so much for that comment mrs akinson i think we definitely staff particularly those who are at the public hearing uh definitely concur with that and uh what our plan to do is to release this update with a superintendent's memo and to really make sure that we're providing that information to the field along with the fact that we'll be looking into a more comprehensive update They will be seeking stakeholder support and involvement as that process develops.

[00:51:20] Thank you. Is there anybody else who has any comments or questions? This is Tammy. I also appreciate the fact that there was some treatment to understanding personal privacy. I think I raised that question as a part of my own review of the information when it was first presented, so I appreciate that that's been addressed.

[00:51:44] Thank you, Dr. Mann. We did take the time to look into that issue and, as you can see, update the executive summary to make sure that the board members could see that change and see the update as reflected so we really appreciate the thoughtful comments that we received during first review it it helps staff to to tie up some of those loosens and to be really clear okay anybody else if not the superintendent of public instruction has asked that we approve the proposed proposed revisions to the family life education guidelines and standards is there a motion to do so

[00:52:18] Motion to approve. Thank you, Ms. Davis-Baud. Is there a second? Second. This is Diane. Yep. Thank you, Ms. Atkinson. Roll call again. Ms. Atkinson? Aye. Ms. Davis-Baud? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms.

Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? I'm sorry, aye. I'm on mute.

[00:52:44] It's okay. Dr. Pexton. Did we lose Dr. Pexton? I'm checking now to see if we lost her. She is still there, but she's muted and may have just had to step away. Okay. Dr. Wilson. Aye. I apologize.

[00:53:12] This is Dr. Pexton. Aye. Perfect. Thanks. You almost left me with an awkward dilemma. So appreciate you getting back. All right. That one carries. We will move on to item J. And thank you, Dr. Hollins. thank you first review of proposed revisions to the computer technology standards of learning and mr saunders yes good afternoon president gecker members of the board dr lang i present

[00:53:47] to you today the proposed 2020 computer technology or ct standards of learning knowing that the seven-year review cycle for standards required revised standards we began work last fall to revise the CT standards the agenda item before you provides details on the committees and their work that has resulted in the standards before you next slide trying to get there there we go these standards are not revised revisions of the current CT standards they replace the current CT standards

[00:54:24] with the hope they will be renamed digital learning integration standards a name more indicative of their content and avoids confusion with the computer science standards. In years past, the focus of the CT standards has been on the use of various technologies and the related skills and the use of those technologies. While those standards have been instrumental in students' learning experiences, the focus on technologies and skills resulted in a significant amount of effort and funding been spent on purchasing technologies without taking into consideration instructional and learning goals and the integration of technologies into

[00:55:02] content area curriculum and instruction the new standards represent a change in mindset to the essential role technologies and the deeper learning experiences of students within content areas that allow them to develop competencies to function in multiple roles in learning and in an ever-increasing digital world next slide those roles are the seven strands you see in the new standards diet powered learner digital citizen knowledge constructor innovative

[00:55:36] designer computational thinker creative communicator and global collaborator next slide prior to the start of work by committees public comments were received during a 30-day comment period 13 comments were received during the comment period of october 2019 through february 2020 and are provided in your board documents comments were positive and included a suggestion to adopt the standards of the International Society for Technology in Education or ISTE, one of the leading

[00:56:13] educational technology advocacy organizations in the world. Next slide. As I mentioned earlier, the proposed standards represent a change in mindset to the essential role of technologies in the deeper learning experiences of students. Learning is the focus, not technology. That is the most significant difference between the current standards and the proposed standards.

[00:56:40] Another difference between the current standards and the proposed standards is the new strands I mentioned earlier, which focus on the multiple roles in which students function in learning and in an ever-increasing digital world. Also, the new format of the proposed standards breaks out the standards by strand with the related learning priorities and grade band performance indicators. Next slide. This new format shows a vertical progression through the grade bands instead of showing a single grade band like the current standards. We have received a good

[00:57:18] amount of positive feedback on the vertical progression for allowing teachers to see the connections among grade bands. Fourth difference is the learning priority component added to the standard statement and performance indicator components of the existing standards. The learning priority helps to connect the standard statement to the performance indicator. The The standard statements, the learning priorities, and the performance indicator are synonymous with goals, objectives, and strategies.

[00:57:52] Next slide. The fifth and final difference between the current standards and the new standards is the wording added to communicate the connection of each of the learning priorities to the relevant attributes of the five Cs.

[00:58:10] As a follow-up to the final standards, work on the creation of crosswalk documents and The learning examples within the content areas will start later this year after the standards have been adopted. The learning examples are intended to help teachers see how the grade band performance indicators can be recognized during instruction and content areas.

[00:58:32] Information is provided on the opening pages of the standards document that address digital learning, positive, safe, legal, and ethical behaviors, and other areas. Next slide.

[00:58:47] Thank you for your time today. I truly believe these new standards will greatly contribute to a higher quality learning experience for students. The impact of recent events in our state and around the world has shown the importance of student technology and virtual learning readiness in the context of learning.

[00:59:05] Are there any questions? - Thank you, Mr. Saunders. Are there any questions or comments from the board? - Mr. Gecker, yes, thank you. May I? - Of course. - Mark, thank you for this great work.

[00:59:21] I think you all have done, I'm particularly impressed at the effort to integrate the standards into the five C's. I think you've done very creative thinking and connecting our digital learning to our learning goals, our overall arching learning goals.

[00:59:41] I'm gonna repeat an issue I think I raised with you back when we first talked about this back in the fall. I still don't understand why these, I think these are great quality and great content, but I still don't understand how they can't be integrated into our computer science and other standards.

[01:00:04] I would, and it may be that these and the computer science standards are both statutorily mandated, in which case we have to put something in these slots regardless. But I just don't like too many extra mandates on our teachers. And this is one that comes, this one predated the computer science standards and maybe there was a way we could have integrated them more in the beginning, but nevertheless, we now have two different sets. And I would say about half the content of these, a lot

[01:00:40] of the digital citizen, et cetera stuff, responsible, ethical use of technology, et cetera, is directly overlaps what's in the computer science material that's in the computer science standards. And a good bit of the other pieces of this overlap things in like the science standards of learning about design thinking and or in other communications, obviously, the communications overlaps.

[01:01:07] And some of that's because of your effort to integrate, I get that. But isn't this just one more thing? And I don't know if this question is fair to ask to you or to Dr. Lane, but isn't this just one more set of instructions that the classroom teachers have to add in on top of everything else and does it you know is

there are there possibilities to combine well the first of the two points you considered the first one is is correct that in terms of legislation the code of

[01:01:41] Virginia does require two separate set of standards. The legislation initially mentioned standards for instructional technology and then in 2016 additional legislation was approved to require standards related to computer science. So that's legislatively that's one reason. The second reason is there really is a difference between computer technology and computer science and again that's

[01:02:17] one of the reasons we're changing the name because that's that's that question has been asked what's what's the difference and I believe when you when you really look into the details the performance indicators specifically with the computer technology standards is drawing on somewhat of a different set of skills from those with computer science. Computer science is really is more related to the power the capabilities of computing devices and realizing those computer technology is somewhat different. But to answer your

[01:02:54] question initially your first reason you gave the legislation requires two separate set of standards. So if I may Mr. Gecker I'll just respond that even thank you for that clarification even if it is in the statute I wonder if our long-term goal ought not to be figure out a way to combine them with or without statutory action and we might be able to combine them with statutory action you and your colleagues did such a good job on the computer science standards making sure that they were not narrowly construed and and therefore there is

[01:03:30] some overlap and I and I don't know whether the whether you've gotten any you know my my only reason for push and so it may be we need to adopt these now and then have an eventual goal of figuring out whether there's a merger possibility but my really only concern is the the one more thing for the classroom teacher to have to manage and if if we're not hearing pushback from the field then maybe that's not a problem I don't know whether other colleagues have thoughts on it this is Jamel could I jump in there President

[01:04:04] of course yes um so it may be useful uh mark to remind us or share with us the level of technical assistance i suspect that there are divisions and localities that have started to do the work or continue to do the work of integrating to miss holton's question figuring out ways to find common threads so that it's not uh that the standards are not one more thing just as we do perhaps across content areas like social science and english as an example but can you talk about ways that we

[01:04:42] know that that the department is helping to find those points of integration or intersectionality and helping divisions do that work and how then as you talk mark about um perhaps the differences between computer science computer technology and other you know digital citizenship and all of those things what are the things that we are already doing to help that and how do you see those mergers and then how do you see that work continuing one of the biggest things and one of the first steps taken was the development of a

[01:05:17] computer science curriculum framework like in most of the other content area when in the other content areas a curriculum framework is provided so a a curriculum framework was created to help teachers also a computer science summit was held to help teachers also understand how to use computer science within the content area those have been the main efforts taken to help school divisions in terms of implementing the computer

[01:05:53] science standards and we haven't heard much we haven't received much pushback in terms of these standards being one more uh thing to do for teachers another thing is the the crosswork crosswalk the idea of a crosswalk that is being done with computer science to show the connection to the content areas and that's something we plan also with the computer technology standards i like them in some ways the the the crossover of the computer science stands and those

[01:06:32] those two areas of of learning computer science computer technology i liken them to the five c's in some way there's a lot of overlap there's a lot of integration there's a lot of places where they they mesh with each other but they each have their own unique characteristics and and so with computer science it it enables a a different level of competency and i guess a good analogy i always give is right now you're looking at a power you're looking at a presentation a powerpoint

[01:07:06] presentation that that was created that's computer it was fairly high level in terms of uh or low level in terms of capability didn't didn't require a lot of technical knowledge versus computer science. You're talking about developing an app, so there are different skill sets there that we're asking of students, but there are those areas of overlap.

[01:07:38] Mr. Gecker, one more comment, if you don't mind. So I think, Mark, thank you for that. I think, you know, Ann, I was thinking about your question a little bit more, and it may be almost like writing and thinking about the difference between teaching writing as a standalone skillset versus integrating the teaching of writing into other content areas.

[01:08:04] And we've worked over many, many years to figure that piece out. I do think that it is important for us as much as possible to recognize just as with writing, many of our teachers have not, don't have the skillset, the particular professional skillset to teach writing.

[01:08:24] And there is a thing about teaching writing um same as it will be for teaching computer technology as well as computer science so i think to whatever extent um i support i certainly support miss holton's suggestion and concern that we are not asking our teachers to do one more thing but supporting them and mark you talked about this as being a different way of approaching this content or this uh this material as a way of thinking as opposed to a skill to do and so i think helping people understand that will be

[01:09:03] very important um and and certainly i know i would imagine that the staff is going to be listening for what the field is telling us they need in the way of support so that this is not one more thing but rather an integrated set of skills and knowledge that we need to to ensure that our students have so focusing on the teacher need really important i support miss holton's comments it's a it's a great idea it's a it's a larger uh undertaking but the the the integrating

[01:09:38] of these two areas together there is an opportunity there it it can be done okay anybody else have any comments um this is diane one of the things i thought about as i was reviewing this material is number one thank you for the material I think it's very well laid out I was really quite impressed by the integration and being able to look at it across across the strands but also across the age groups but I was thinking and then this is sort of a piggyback on what Jamel was saying

[01:10:14] is I think about our teachers that are currently in the classroom and especially under the current circumstances the needs that they may have had to be able to do better related to providing online learning for our students but I also think about our future teachers and so I wonder to what degree are we

our teacher prep programs going to be incorporating information such as these new standards into their preparation programs because i think that is um incredibly vital you are exactly right it is it

[01:10:54] is very similar to the task laid before us with computer science standards maintaining that connection with the teacher prep programs to prepare those teachers so it's it's very similar to to the test that we have with computer science so just as we continue to work with our institutions of higher education in terms of computer science we will do the same with computer technology computer technology has a longer history of of already working with teacher prep programs a lot of those programs already have instructional technology programs so we will tap into that

[01:11:33] existing relationship that we have with them and sort of continue to grow that thank you anybody else. If not, thank you, Mr. Saunders very much. The board is happy to accept the proposed revisions on first review. Item K, first review of the advisory board on teacher education and licensure recommendation to establish dual language endorsements. Good morning, Dr.

[01:12:07] Can you hear me? This is Patty. Hello, Patty. How are you? Hi, good to hear and see you. President Gecker, members of the board and Dr. Lane, it's so nice to be here with you today. it certainly is my pleasure to present for first review the advisory board on teacher education and licensure recommendation to establish dual language endorsements pre-k through six in the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in virginia first i want to publicly thank the work group for dual language for its excellent work and the board of education

[01:12:45] approved requirements for for dual language pre-k through six endorsement for the licensure regulations for school personnel on November 14, 2019. On January 13 of 2020, the Advisory Board unanimously recommended proposed regulations for dual language endorsements to be added to the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia. Since I presented detailed background in November and you have reviewed the board item, I will not present that

[01:13:21] information again the document before you today is a companion to the licensure regulations already approved by the board in november that outlined the competencies required in educator preparation programs for these endorsements the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education waive first review and approve abtel's recommendation to establish dual language endorsements pre-K through six in the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia. Thank you. Thank you. Are there any questions by members

[01:14:01] of the board or discussion? I'm not seeing any or hearing any. Is there a motion then to waive first review and adopt these regulations? I make a motion to waive first review and adopt this okay thank you dr duran is there a second second thank you miss davis vodt uh just to be sure is there any comment or question if not uh the roll call miss atkinson aye miss davis vodt

[01:14:38] aye dr duran aye miss holton aye dr mann aye dr pexton aye dr wilson aye i vote aye thank you Thank you very much. Next item also you Ms. Pitts. Item L, ABTEL's recommendation to establish economics and personal finance endorsement add-on.

[01:15:02] Correct. This is the first review of ABTEL's recommendation to establish an economics and personal finance add-on endorsement in both the licensure regulations for school personnel and the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia.

[01:15:21] The Department of Education did convene a work raise of experts to make recommendations for requirements for the add-on endorsement in economics and personal finance, and I do want to thank the members for their extraordinary work. Currently, Virginia does not have a specific endorsement to teach economics and personal finance.

[01:15:43] Teachers holding a Virginia license with endorsements in specific areas of career and technical education, social sciences, and mathematics may teach the courses. The add-on endorsement will expand the number of educators who may teach the economics and personal finance course.

[01:16:01] ABTEL received the work group recommendations, and in addition to the requirements that ABTEL is recommending for the add-on endorsement, they further recommend current teachers of the course, the grandfather, to receive the add-on endorsement in economics and personal finance without an application fee, and that the board approve a two-year window of time for teachers to seek the endorsement prior to the add-on endorsement being required statewide. That would give teachers

[01:16:36] time to get the endorsement, those interested, before it is required statewide. You have the recommended endorsement requirements before you, but I'd like to briefly go over the requirements an individual would need to complete based upon the recommendations of ABTEL. They would have to complete six semester hours of economics or three semester hours of economics and a non-college credit institute in economics and six semester hours of finance or three semester hours of

[01:17:15] personal finance and a non-college credit institute in finance. The non-college credit institute could be offered by a school division or a regionally accredited college or university as proposed by abtel the superintendent's recommendation is as follows that the board of education receive for first review abtel's recommendations to establish an economics and personal finance add-on endorsement in the licensure regulations for school personnel

[01:17:50] and the regulations governing the review and approval with education programs in virginia so if you have any questions be happy to try to answer those are there any questions thank - Thank you, Ms. Spitz. - Mr. Getcher. - Okay, Ms. Atkinson.

[01:18:08] - This is Diane. So there, in addition to the changes in the regulations, my understanding of the item is that when we get to vote on it the next time we meet as a board, is that we also need to approve the plan for implementation.

[01:18:24] And so I just wanted to highlight that because I believe there's a related to grandfathering, the current teachers, and then the two year time period, which is separate and apart from the regulations. - Yeah.

[01:18:41] - Mr. Gecker. - Dr. Lane. - Thank you. Thank you board members for giving me a chance to speak on this item and Patty and to all the members of ABTEL, thank you so much for putting this together. Mr. Gecker, I wanted you to know that the department plans to make recommendations in adjustment, an adjustment to what ABTEL has recommended.

[01:19:08] And I wanted to let you know couple concerns we had with the ABTEL recommendation. We did not change anything for your presentation today because we wanted you to purely see it as recommended from ABTEL. And just so you know, I've had one conversation already with Dan Mortensen, who is the head of the Virginia Council on Economic Education, and by the time this comes to you on

second review, we'll do some additional engagement. But when Ms. Pitts was walking you through ABTEL's recommendation and if you're if you're in the document uh attachment b lays out the add-on

[01:19:48] endorsement requirements and as as was mentioned uh you know you would be required to do six hours of economics and you could you could achieve that by three hours of economics and a non-college credit institute in economics so that you could essentially do a course and then a 45-hour block to earn that and then then the teacher also has to do a six semester at six semester hours in finance which could also be achieved through three hours in personal finance and then a non-college

[01:20:24] credit institute and uh to be honest when when we uh originally talked with the virginia council on economic education who was really pushing for this add-on endorsement um we we had initial conversations that led us to believe that the non-credit institutes would be the primary role that this would be done. And we have some concerns about asking teachers to take 12 college credits to do this. As you know, this is a graduation requirement. And when it was first made a graduation requirement, there was not necessarily additional funding provided to implement the

[01:21:03] course. And so many school divisions implemented this course with a variety of teachers that made it possible to offer this in schedules. And so, you know, you could have physical education teachers teaching this, career and technical education teachers teaching this, social studies and history teachers teaching this, and maybe even mathematics teachers, amongst other endorsement areas. Now, whereas we appreciate that those folks would be grandfathered, we still believe that predominantly in schools, this will be taught by teachers who have an endorsement in another area and are teaching other subjects. And this would, that's why it's an add-on endorsement, be an add-on

[01:21:43] to their current endorsements to be able to allow them flexibility in their schedules to teach this course. And we just believe that 12 college credits is a higher standard than we were thinking for this requirement. And so the department is going to look at some options and upon second review, we'll lay those out for you. But initial thinking that we have right now is to ask the board to consider maybe half of these requirements, which would be essentially three hours in

[01:22:17] economics that could be completed through a non-college credit institute and three hours of finance which could also be completed institute so that teachers could choose rather than only earning this through college credit at least in the in the first six hours that all of the endorsement could be done through institutes and economics and institutes and personal finance and so we will make final decision making before second review but i didn't want you to leave this item without knowing the department does plan to make some recommended changes mr gecker this is

[01:22:55] jamelle wilson i'd just like to ask dr lane or miss pitts i appreciate dr lane that explanation i was curious about why we are making this recommendation at this particular time um and kind of where the impetus was and so um i don't know if we have uh beyond the october date which is in the materials i i just i'm curious about why now uh you know uh so if you can help us understand that a little bit more. Yeah, thank you. And I alluded at that, but I'll certainly

[01:23:27] go into more depth. Thank you, Dr. Wilson. The impetus really came from the economics education, Virginia Council for Economics Education. They came to us. And to be honest, as we've looked at our schools, we feel strongly about our economics and personal finance programs. But when you think about the necessary life skills that a student needs to require for their future. There are many of these courses being offered in some cases, not everywhere, where the teachers may have

[01:24:02] very little background in economics and personal finance. And so we didn't want to put a licensure requirement on this at the onset while we were transitioning. But now that we're several years into this and have even adopted new graduation requirements and this continues to be a part of it and of course it has the statutory mandate. We want to make sure that the education that students are receiving in a mandate is done in a manner that ensures that the content knowledge is there for all of the educators. I believe that all of our educators are gaining that and they're doing it in their own way but we often use the licensure requirements and the add-on endorsement to make

[01:24:41] sure that we can create a solid foundation there and so when this was brought to us by the Council on Economics Education we agreed that enough time had passed to require an endorsement but we were we were essentially pretty strong in our belief that it shouldn't be an overwhelming requirement which is why we were thinking about a change in the recommendation and we also wanted to make sure that teachers that had been teaching it for many years were not required to do something new since they had gained expertise and having already taught the course so we wanted to make sure that there was the grandfathering notion and so that is that is the impetus for now uh we understand that it will take some time to implement it so we wanted to start the process now so

[01:25:20] if at a time in the future the board wanted to mandate the license you could do that right now we just wanted to create the add-on endorsement without actually creating the mandate for the endorsement to actually teach the course uh so that school divisions continue to have flexibility I do appreciate the idea of thinking about alternative ways to amass the score to demonstrate the skills necessary that that is pleasing you know it's a I think it's a great idea to think differently there are a lot of different ways that we can gain knowledge it doesn't have to be

[01:25:58] three credits listen to that coming from a university person I can't believe I said that out out loud. Yeah, our initial dream for this was a two-week summer institute where essentially you did 40 or 45 credits in one week, 40 or 45 credits in another week, and that the teacher would have a solid foundation without it having to be almost a minor in the topic area to use university parlance. Yeah, Mr. Gecker, if I just may weigh in, I agree. I think this is too much, and also might we might want to look at a longer phase in period but if you reduce the amount then that may

[01:26:38] not be so crucial okay we appreciate the heads up on where we're going with this or at least where the department's going and uh we'll accept this item on first review unless there are any other comments i will accept it either way but if there are any other comments let's have them now okay we're at about 220 we have three items left uh you know i will say this has gone much more quickly than anticipated uh i am content either way taking a break or pushing through uh is there

[01:27:15] any sense of the board on this i'm happy to push through okay i agree there we go then okay i agree i will say having the meetings this way certainly does cut down a lot of the chatter we usually have so i'm thinking if we could implement this in an in-person meeting now mr gecker don't get too crazy now all right item m first review division level memorandum of understanding for danville

[01:27:49] city's public schools thank you mr gecker board members and dr lane um linda revia here from the office of school quality and i appreciate this opportunity to bring to you for first review the division level memorandum of understanding for danville city public schools if you may remember in September Dr. Jones who is the superintendent of Danville City Public Schools had approached Dr. Lane and with your approval had gotten the

[01:28:27] opportunity to enter into a division level review which was conducted under the supervision of the Office of School Quality with representation from across the agency. We completed this review in December and worked on the results, the division level review findings through January and February. In the handout that you received, we've tried to give you a broad overview of the work. These Danville City Public Schools has, over several years,

[01:29:06] demonstrated some challenges with having its schools accredited and so the other thing that you can see in your report is there's been numerous opportunities to provide support and the division level review is really not working specifically with each school but with the division level leadership and based on the findings we have talked with Dr. Lane and are recommending a memorandum of understanding for danville city public schools i'm pleased to report that dr jones and his staff have been working with us already to review the division

[01:29:46] level review findings and begin wrapping their minds around a corrective action plan that is unique to the needs that were identified for the school division so i bring this to you for first okay thank you for that are there any questions uh if i may dr yeah can you remind us what other divisions are under mous now just i'm just trying to get a sense of the volume you all are managing yes ma'am we currently have three school divisions that are in a board of education memorandum of

[01:30:23] understanding that would be richmond public schools uh petersburg city public schools and in Greensville County public schools. - And am I right? We have on our agenda today, one more after this, okay. - Yes, ma'am.

[01:30:39] - And so do you have the, does your office have, recognizing that this, the MOU process requires significant resources from you and your office, do you have the capacity to manage all of those adequately if both of these two come under?

[01:30:58] not not that that should just govern whether we put somebody on our mou but if we do we need to make sure we have the capacity to respond appropriately thank you miss holton for that question and i appreciate the consideration of our staff i would say that yes we do have that capacity because the work is done not just by the office of school quality but also delving into the resources of the agency as a whole and I am pleased to report that we've approached these two MOUs in a slightly different manner than the past and have

[01:31:36] engaged already with both of these superintendents and their staff to get significant engagement from them so instead of doing something to them we are partnering with them and I think that bodes well for the successful implementation of the MOU. Thank you. Anybody else have any questions or comments on this item? We'll say I've been to I guess the meetings with all three of the jurisdictions now that we have under MOU and it is clear that

[01:32:11] mostly it is treated as a partnership, Ms. Halton, and we expect to see, I expect to see improvement based upon the personnel in place and the jurisdictions. So, you know, I remember, and I've talked about this before, I guess my first or second meeting on the board years ago was when we adopted the 13th Petersburg MOU, and I just couldn't help but thinking, why are we doing this if we're not really helping? And, you know, I'm at the point now where I believe that the intervention of the department will yield substantial benefit

[01:32:51] as we move forward very impressed with the approach and uh very impressed with the way the department is being received when we go to the meetings and uh the care being taken locally so you know i i do appreciate the concern about personnel but i will tell you that having seen it firsthand i think we're doing good things here and moving very positively forward yeah yes i'm a very strong proponent of the approach and yet it does require resources so we just need to make sure either aren't spreading them too thin or that we are beefing up the resources as need be but

[01:33:29] i'm happy to hear that things are going well and that uh apparently do have the resources to take on two more okay so we'll move on we'll take that one on first review we'll move on to item n uh first review of the division level memorandum of understanding for prince edward county public schools and so in your packet you have a very similar item to what we just looked at i am also pleased to report that dr johnson who's the superintendent of prince edward county public schools has been working closely with us and her staff with the office of school quality staff this

[01:34:06] is again the result of a request for a division level review made by the superintendent and was approved by the board of education in september of 19 and so these two division level reviews were actually done somewhat concurrently we did the same process as I just described with Danville you can see that the that Prince Edward County has experienced challenges and having their schools either fully accredited under the previous accreditation system are now having their schools accredited they

[01:34:45] are accredited with conditions it's a smaller school division and I'm pleased to report that the way that we implemented the division level review that in the development of the findings report that they are not cookie cutter reports of one another they are exemplary of the unique needs that were identified in Prince Edward County public schools and in fact we had a meeting yesterday with the superintendent and the assistant soup and Dr. Holloman, the Associate Director of the Office of School Quality and myself to discuss

[01:35:21] moving forward with the development of a corrective action plan that is uniquely slanted and directed at the needs of Prince Edward County. So I, without being redundant, would bring this to you for first review.

[01:35:39] Any questions or comments here? If not, thank you very much. And we will accept that item for first review. Thank you, sir. Thank you. All right. Now, I understand on item O, Ms. Atkinson will recuse. That is correct.

[01:35:57] Thank you, Ms. Atkinson. And let's move to item O, first review of revisions to the list of 2021 Board of Ed approved industry certifications, et cetera. Sir Wilcox. Thank you, President Becker. As required by board regulations, the Office of Rear Technical adult education presents the additions to deletions from the list of industry certifications occupational competency assessments and professional licenses to meet the requirements

[01:36:36] on pages c through h of your board item in in summary these industry credentials will apply to students entering the ninth grade prior to 2018-19 and students entering the ninth grade in 2018-19 and beyond. First, the requirements for graduation with a standard diploma and an advanced studies

[01:37:10] diploma effect students who enter the ninth grade prior to 2018-19 three key points students who complete a cte program sequence and pass an industry credential may substitute the industry credential for a the industry selected verified credit and b either a laboratory science or

[01:37:41] history and social science verified credit. Two, any one board approved certification will satisfy the standard diploma graduation requirement for the CTE credential. And three, students pursuing the advanced studies diploma may utilize additional tests for earning verified credit in computer science technology cte economics and other areas as prescribed by the board for verified credit

[01:38:19] second the requirements for graduation with a standard diploma or advanced studies diploma for for students who entered the ninth grade in 2018 2019 and beyond for the standard diploma students who complete a cte program sequence of courses and passes a board approved industry credential may substitute it for either a laboratory science or history and social science verified credit

[01:38:56] when the credential confers more than one verified credit further in accordance with the standards of quality students shall either complete an advanced placement honors our international baccalaureate course or earn a cte credential approved by the board also students are eligible to earn the board of education approved seal in cte advanced mathematics and technology and stem

[01:39:35] for the standard and advanced studies diploma it should be noted that industry credentials often are continuously being revised or discontinued and new ones created to stay current with technology and new skills and techniques in the workplace and to ensure that the credentials are relevant and recognized by business and industry as listed on pages i

[01:40:09] through k 32 credentials have been added 19 credentials have been discontinued by the providers and no longer are offered these adjustments will result in a total of 452 board approved credentials it is the superintendent of public instructions recommendation that the

[01:40:39] board of education way first review and approve the 32 new industry uh certification examinations occupational competency assessments and professional licenses to meet the board of education is requirement for one graduation effective for students who entered the ninth grade prior to 2018-19 school year two requirement for graduation effective for students who entered

[01:41:13] the ninth grade in 2018-19 school year and three requirements for cte advanced mathematics and technology and stem seal further that the board approved the removal of the 19 credentials which are no longer offered by the providers uh is there any are there any questions or comments

[01:41:42] by board members not hearing or seeing anybody come forward so uh superintendent has requested that we wait first review and approve is there a motion to do so so moved wave first review and approved dr dron thank you dr duran is there a second second second thank you mr dr wilson uh roll call again miss atkinson i recuse my sorry yes yes thanks yeah i told emily to step

[01:42:19] in when i messed this all up but she didn't catch me in time uh miss davis vaut hi dr duran hi miss holton hi dr mann hi dr pexton hi and dr wilson i and mr gecker actually that was dr pexton who seconded. Oh, I'm sorry. It showed up on the screen as if you were speaking. We both were speaking at the same time, and I think I may have jumped in front of her. Yes, strange. The way the screen is set up for me, I don't have Dr. Paxton on it, but you still somehow made the cut. I'm not

[01:42:57] sure why that is, but that's the way this is going. Okay, well, perfect. Thank you, Dr. Paxton, and I voted yes, and so that one carries. All right, we had two written reports. Any comments or questions about those this is Diane yes I have a comment about and really more of a question and I'm trying to get my other device back to the front okay on the summary of the proposed early childhood state agency transition one of the questions there was related to the board and as I was reading through that

[01:43:36] material I was thinking about whether or not or or suggesting that it was probably important for the board to ask that an analysis be done to anticipate what type of time requirements would be put on the board for them to be the board for early childhood so that the board can start to think about calendars what skill sets etc that the board

[01:44:15] might need and so other other than acknowledging that the board is a comprised of very intelligent people and we now actually have a member on the board who is who is has expertise in this area I think we need to do a bit more analysis than that and just would like to highlight that. It's a fair comment. Anybody else?

[01:44:43] Yes, I'd like to chime also on that same item to just suggest that recognizing we're working in this altered environment but that it would be lovely for us to get an update on that soon. I confess to not having read the General Assembly update as closely as I should have but I don't know where we actually landed in the final analysis in the assembly on the early childhood plans, whether the budget unallocations, budget freeze, affected the plans in any way, and I'd just love to

[01:45:19] hear an update on where we are, not today, but perhaps we can do it at the June meeting, if we can have a presentation on where we are and next steps, and what do we need to do to start preparing along the lines of what Diane was suggesting.

[01:45:34] mr gecker i can give the 30 second version now with a promise for a longer later if you would like sure it'd be helpful james so miss holton uh the the the transition of the early childhood and specifically the block grant which is the the big funding stream there was approved uh the primary unallotment was related to uh supplemental funds and and the way that we were going to uh payout costs related to vpi that was unallotted but the rest of the the broader transition the

[01:46:09] the the existing slots for vpi plus everything else remains in the plans and the required reporting to the general assembly and everything else and um with this so the the early childhood transition plan that you see here in the written reports remains and we'll come back with more detail in the future great thank you okay any other commentary yes dr president gecker i actually had a comment as well interestingly enough um i think the questions that have been asked about early childhood were certainly on my mind but in addition as i read the update on the 2020

[01:46:46] general assembly and i hearken back to the conversation we were having earlier in the meeting about um uh computer science and technology i as i read through that report and thank you emily so very much for pulling all of that together and providing a very nice overview of all the actions, some that were successful and others not, it was very interesting to read in the sense that I couldn't help but wonder where are the guardrails to some things because

[01:47:23] you feel, I mean, I was so excited with the revision of the health standards because they actually did do a very good job of incorporating attention to social-emotional mental health and wellness and again i'm a mental health person by profession and yet i i see a call for another set of standards that focus on another dimension of social-emotional you know development it just really did make me want to appreciate how how to understand sort of where how code is is is set

[01:48:02] on the general assembly side the role of the board as a new board member i think that kind of historical overview at some other time would be very welcomed it would it certainly will help me situate

what i see is just a voluminous ask upon our systems to constantly be doing more with less um and children being compromised uh in in the midst of it so i just offer that comment

[01:48:35] as something to come back to at some point well i think it's a good topic for us to discuss honestly um i don't have all the history uh but among board members here assembled i think quite a bit of the history could be pieced together about uh you know and dr mann you weren't with us when we started the uh work program the comprehensive work plan and actually did a fair amount of discussion of the constitutional background of the board that is our rights and powers under the constitution

[01:49:14] of virginia uh and then frankly how they sort of eroded and you know our efforts to bring them back i mean it's a longer history than we have nothing we have time for that's not fair but it would be more disjointed today and we could put it together in a better fashion but if you look even at uh sort of our influence over the standards of quality it sort of tracks i think the legislative action with regard to education in the commonwealth and as our advice waned as our as a body

[01:49:51] historically waned you know 20 plus years ago uh the assembly filled that void and that void has not been given back. I would say that's a fair short form assessment. Ms. Halton, you have any comments on that? I know you've been around for a while and Ms. Atkinson, you actually have the much broader view of history here. You know, I would appreciate some comments if you have them.

[01:50:17] I'm not putting you on the spot to do it, but if you wouldn't mind, because this is, you know, again, Dr. Mann, one of the things I talked about and we talked about, you know, a couple of years ago was how do we restore the board to the position of being the preeminent policy education policy body in the commonwealth and move you know respectfully we can't move them but to thereby allow the assembly to step back a little bit and let some of the broader themes of education

[01:50:52] be hashed out here first before they become code. Ms. Houlton I can see you nodding so I don't know if that means you want to speak or if you want to duck this one. Well I'll just briefly but the one thing I would say I mean you're absolutely right Tammy there's there's always a lot of legislation on education but this year was particularly heavy and you know partly because education is important and so our legislators are paying a lot of attention and there are a lot of issues that people care about. I do think this year

[01:51:26] may have been heavier than some and frankly more substantive than some and and part of that's because of the leadership change there was a lot of pent-up demand and the leadership changes in both houses unleashed some of that but I do I do think over time you know how to help the assembly get to the balance of giving us the top-level policy guidance but not one example of how detailed our direction the direction to the whole education system has gotten is how many things we needed to ask for their permission to waive in this

[01:52:06] current crisis and you know exactly what you know that students have to take CPR in an in-person basis for instance and that's not in code that's not in regulation or guidance that's actually in code and so the assembly had to act in this emergency way to authorize James to seek waivers of some of those many many many provisions and so maybe there's an opportunity for us to have a discussion amongst ourselves and then meet with legislators and help them understand our perspective on how we appreciate their guidance at the at the

[01:52:42] top level but it's gotten awfully prescriptive and not just to us but then it trickles down absolutely as you say absolutely to the teacher in the classroom even what we discussed earlier about the the standards for instance I understand because I've been there and I'm I was one of the folks who helped push through I think the requirement if I remember correctly for the computer science standards and you know should we have thought then well shouldn't we just alter these prior computer technology standards to broaden to include but no that's not the way we did it so things just get added never never does anything

[01:53:19] get taken away. Thank you Ms. Atkinson you have anything to add? Well I will say one of the things I observed more than anything else this time reading through the materials that Emily so provided for us and let me just also piggyback on what a wonderful job she has done but one of the things that i really identified was the degree of items put on the agency there are some things the board has to do but there is a significant amount of things that the general assembly has asked the agency to do and as i was reading through those i

[01:53:59] was beginning to worry about the capacity of the agency to do all of that um i i think one of the things that i worry about as as i think about it is oftentimes pieces of legislation come through because of the particular instance in a particular jurisdiction and then the question i would ask in my mind is is is statewide policy change necessary because of an issue that arose in one jurisdiction and but but the other aspect of it is i is really to determine whether the um general assembly

[01:54:36] really has a idea of the larger picture of where we need to go with our students and I feel like there's a lot of piecemeal work and sometimes piecemeal work doesn't do a good job of putting those pieces into the big picture and so you know looking at the numbers that have come through and I was you know very involved in it 20 years ago it is significantly many more pieces and I'll I'll give an example of one item.

[01:55:09] We have an item in there that passed asking us to redo guidelines for work-based learning. We just passed those guidelines. I don't understand why we need to do new ones. We just did a set of guidelines and I thought the guidelines that we just put together were very comprehensive.

[01:55:29] And so, anyways, I probably should, I'm probably articulating things that many other people share. Yeah. President Garrett, this is Emily. I will just chime in to provide a little bit of context, and I think this is certainly a conversation that we can continue to have.

[01:55:51] Dr. Mann, you are correct that we saw an exorbitant amount of legislation. I will say the report that we provided to you all is only that legislation that passed. There was significantly more legislation that was not passed.

[01:56:09] On the flip side of that, I will say from a staff perspective, we had much more dialogue with legislators and as well as committee leadership this year. they were coming to us asking for guidance and for help.

[01:56:30] That's not to say that we cannot continue to improve that. And I think that we will. And I think that obviously given the pandemic, things might be a little bit different, but also the board engaging more with legislators is gonna be important to provide that holistic picture.

[01:56:48] And that is something that the leadership is interested in making sure that they they know kind of where the department's going where the board is going so that they can be helpful in moving things forward um but we still have to recognize that they also represent certain constituency groups um and

certainly have their their own agenda as well but i think um we can continue to work on the board's partnership and the department's partnership with with the legislature and i'll mention this might be a good segue we do have a new assistant secretary assistant superintendent for policy equity and communications

[01:57:26] holly coy who is officially at the department now um and so between myself and holly and dr leslie sale as our new director of policy i think that we'll be able to to work together um as a department and as a board to continue to to improve um our connections with them uh thank you if i may just one more thing. I said nothing ever gets taken away and that is actually not entirely accurate and there were a couple of requirements this year that were eliminated and so actually legislative

[01:58:03] action to reduce some of the division's reporting requirements on incidents that have to be reported to the juvenile apparatus so so it's not it's some things are our actions that roll back other requirements that's that's not the worst thing in the world and also just like to say Emily not to contradict but to perhaps clarify although Diane and I met with a large number

[01:58:35] of legislators during the session we were not able to use DOE staff in any of those meetings you know DOE staff is bound to the governor's budget and the governor's policies and when the governor did not adopt really any of these standards of quality language the board wanted we were left out there you know without assistance essentially not to say we didn't get help in the background but in terms of meeting and lobbying that was all us and you know I do think it will will be helpful as we move forward,

[01:59:14] and I have talked to James about this, and he's not committed to do this, I'm not putting words in his mouth, that to the extent we can get our agendas aligned much earlier in the process, it would help us a great deal more during the legislative session. I will also say that Jim Dillard used to harangue me and others about why don't we have a legislative committee?

[01:59:37] And I will say, I'm coming to the conclusion that he's right, that we actually ought to form a subset of us to begin to deal more seriously with the legislature and begin to talk policy with legislators not in session but well prior to session so that they can have a much better idea what our thought process is and you know again the overarching view of where the commonwealth ought to be going with education and so you know as we move forward this year it is that is a topic i would like to have on our agenda is how do we do

[02:00:14] that because frankly the next legislative session will be here before we know it and we do have coming off the soq work uh significant policy uh positions that the board has taken as a whole that ought to be promoted through the legislature so anybody else on this topic or any other well on the any other does that get to the discussion generally I'd love to just take a minute Dan to just applaud the department's work you all it's

[02:00:50] incredible how vigorously have you have continued going forward as evidenced by our substantive agenda today recognizing that you're doing all of that in telework environment and while you're doing incredible work supporting the education field and also to go back to where we started Dan started by recognizing that this is teacher appreciation week and I'll just chime in my my addition of appreciation for what our educators are doing across the Commonwealth in these very challenging times. Thank you Ms. Holton.

[02:01:27] The additional time you have to spend on all this is because you've stopped shaving? Mr. President. Yes, Dr. Durand. Yes, first I would like to say welcome to assistant superintendent Holly Coy it's great to continue to work with you in a new role and very excited that you're part of our team now and in a different role because you've been part of the team for many years always been a pleasure to work with you I have a question and maybe a superintendent Lane you're about to share this but I would love superintendent Lane if you could provide an overview to a brief overview to the board and the public on what's

[02:02:04] happening with the state-level COVID education task force that's going to be coming with some guidance and whatnot in early June. Some questions I've heard and seen coming by after the result of Maryland issuing their recovery plan, but we have one that's been happening and it's work going through the process that you're leading.

[02:02:22] So I'd love whatever bit of information you could provide to us in the public in a brief overview. Thank you. - Yeah, thank you, Dr. Duran. And actually you did two topics. And so if you don't mind, Mr. Gecker, I'm gonna handle both. And Emily and Dr. Duran both referenced this.

[02:02:40] But one of the things I wanted to do today is to formally introduce you to our new assistant superintendent for policy, equity, and communications, Holly Coy. As you know, Holly comes to us as the former deputy secretary of education for the past two administrations.

[02:02:58] And just want to take a quick moment and as we would normally do in person and ask Holly to say hello and introduce herself in this new role. But as our new assistant superintendent, Holly, I want to say congratulations and thank you for coming over to the agency to lead this incredible work on our behalf.

[02:03:18] Well, thank you all for that warm welcome. I really appreciate it. I am thrilled to be stepping into this new role officially and looking forward to working on issues together in this new capacity. I'll just note two things, given the last conversations you all have had. One, that a huge dose is appropriate for Emily and Leslie and their teams through this session. They just did an incredible amount of work in a really high

[02:03:50] quality way and just want to thank them for all that work during session. And second, just want to note kind of that I heard the conversation around how we engage the General Assembly in the off session, quote unquote, and have some ideas about how we might be doing that and look forward to working together with you all on that in the coming months.

[02:04:14] Thank you. And. Go ahead, James. No, no, no, please. Please. I was just going to tell Holly I'll no longer be able to call her my favorite deputy secretary now that she is no longer. Fran will get to wear that title honorably.

[02:04:30] There you go. All right, James. Yeah, and I'll just wrap that up by also echoing Holly's thank you to Emily, Leslie, and the entire policy team. What an incredible job they did during the session. Board members may not know, but we write a fiscal impact and an administrative impact on every single education bill, whether it passes or not.

[02:04:55] And those are done on a very tight timeline. And then once we have governor's positions, that team takes the lead on advocating for the governor's position in the General Assembly. And they just did

really incredible work. But transitioning, Dr. Duran, to your question, there's so much going on in the COVID-19 response.

[02:05:14] I'll be remiss to say that I'm going to share everything. But specifically, Virginia, as you know, is the second state in the nation. The Commonwealth is the second state in the nation to close schools for the rest of the academic term.

[02:05:31] And so our initial work, which you've been briefed on in writing, was primarily focused on responding to the crisis and putting in guidance to get us to the end of the year, and you discussed that at length in your last board meeting.

[02:05:49] Following your last board meeting, the department turned our efforts from being responsive to the crisis to beginning to think about how we will recover from the crisis. So we immediately launched a recovery task force, which two of our board members are on the recovery task force, and they are tasked with essentially thinking not about when schools will reopen, but how they should reopen and what will be needed to support students, teachers, and families through that process.

[02:06:20] As a part of that task force, there is a subcommittee of that task force that's just focused on reopening and essentially the final decisions about reopening and when will be made by the governor. So we anticipate that within the next few weeks, the initial reports from both of those, the subgroup and the larger task force will be issued, we'll take that to the governor and the health professionals to make sure it aligns to the data and safety protocols that they find are appropriate, and then we'll issue that report to the public.

[02:06:55] While that is going on, we also have a task force just thinking about accreditation, which Diane Atkinson sits on. And in thinking through accreditation, not only what accreditation will look like in the future, but how will we assess how students are doing upon their return in the absence of a fall and a spring SOL, which we've already announced would not be an option.

[02:07:19] And so that is another piece of the work that's going on. And then our fourth task force already wrapped up, and that was on continuity of learning, and we issued that early in the process. And so meanwhile, while that is going on, the Secretary of Education is leading a broader PK, or I would say birth to 20 task force, that's making sure that we're aligning efforts between higher ed, our K-12 recovery efforts, and early childhood efforts.

[02:07:45] And it's from that task force that I think we'll make some of the bigger recommendations around when and not necessarily how we'll support our educators, as I mentioned in our task force, but what the health requirements will be.

[02:08:01] And, of course, the governor will make those final decisions. So a lot of work going on in that space. I anticipate that our reports, like I said, will be out in the month of May. And we just wanted to make sure that in addition to what we were ready to state from the task force and department, that the governor and our health officials have a chance to weigh in all that before it goes public.

[02:08:24] So we're getting very, very close. Thank you for that overview. I really appreciate it, Dr. Lane. And we will also plan on potentially at our June meeting to prepare, you know, kind of a lengthier update on the work of these task forces, as well as the waivers.

[02:08:45] waivers that have been issued as it you know relates to the the flexibility language that passed the general assembly we'll be sure to give the board a full update in june okay anybody else have any questions or comments this is diane atkinson um just an acknowledgement i don't know if other people know this but our former secretary of education from the allen administration beverly scrow passed away maybe a month ago and just to acknowledge her and the wonderful job that

[02:09:21] she did and just to acknowledge her the sorrow her family's feeling thank you ms atkinson for bringing that to our attention is there anybody else if not uh let me thank emily and staff as always uh you know this came off relatively i think flawlessly except for my asking diane to vote on a matter she'd recused and with that small non-technological glitch uh you know we really appreciate it emily has been working i know very very hard on not only this but on the task forces

[02:10:00] and everything else and i'm not quite sure how she's finding the time to keep this all moving but fortunately for us she is and we're very appreciative as always uh thankful to susan williams for being with us from the ag's office making sure that this works this is clearly not our preferred way of meeting but given the you know times we're in it may be the only way for a while uh i appreciate everybody doing the work in advance so that we can move through these meetings in such a you know high quality fashion uh with that if there is nothing else i think uh the plan

[02:10:38] is to have a meeting in june and look forward to seeing you all then if not before so stay safe and uh we are adjourned thank you thank you dan thank you thank you bye everyone stay healthy bye bye bye everybody bye bye

